# Policy & Strategy Lab

## Workbook 6: Testing and Synthesis

| Participant | |
|---|---|
| Name | |
| Case (problem statement) | |
| Decision-making role and decision | |
| Pod | |

### How to use this workbook

Each worksheet applies one day's anchor tool to your own case. Complete it during the session and finish it in your independent time. Keep earlier versions: revision is credited, so record what changed and why in the feedback box at the end of each worksheet. Tag every substantive claim in your Analyst's Ledger as fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

**Competencies practised in this workbook:** E6, F3, F4, F5, I1, J3, J4.

**Gate 3.** This workbook ends with Gate 3. Submit the revised worksheets listed on the final worksheet, with a revision note and an AI-use disclosure.

**Using AI tools.** You may use AI tools to suggest structures, rival explanations or improvements to your writing. You may not use AI output as evidence. Every fact, figure, citation and description of an institution must come from a source you have checked.

## Worksheet 6.1: Hypothesis testing matrix

*Day 14: Testing the hypotheses. Anchor tool: Hypothesis testing matrix.*

**Purpose.** Decide which explanations survive the evidence, and say how confident you are.

**In brief.**

- Look for the evidence that could prove you wrong, not more that agrees.
- Make arguments checkable: claim, evidence and warrant.
- Record verdicts honestly. Unresolved is a legitimate finding.
- Concede what a challenge shows. It strengthens the analysis.

**Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative).** Madhyapur (illustrative): H1, the contract, supported with the vehicle rival partly true; H2, containers, weakened; H3, processing, partly supported; H4, enforcement, the rival supported: fines alone backfire.

**Instructions.**

1. For each hypothesis, list supporting and disconfirming evidence, with sources.
2. Record a verdict: supported, weakened or unresolved.
3. Rate your confidence and say why.
4. Write your strongest finding as claim, evidence and warrant.
5. Record the red team's challenges and your revised claim.

### Hypothesis testing matrix

| Hypothesis | Supporting evidence (sources) | Disconfirming evidence (sources) | Verdict | Confidence and why |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |

### Strongest finding

| Claim | Evidence | Warrant |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

### Red team record

| Challenge | My response | Change to the claim |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

| Challenge | My response | Change to the claim |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

**Reflection.**

1. Which hypothesis did the evidence weaken, and how does that change your diagnosis?
2. Where did you defend rather than analyse?
3. What would resolve your most important unresolved hypothesis?

| My reflections |
|---|
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| |
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**Quality checklist.**

- ☐ Every hypothesis has a verdict.
- ☐ Disconfirming evidence is recorded honestly.
- ☐ The strongest finding is stated as claim, evidence and warrant.
- ☐ Red team challenges and responses are recorded.

**Hand in.** Worksheet 6.1 by the start of Day 15, for Gate 3.

**Before the next session.** Revise your diagnosis in the light of the verdicts. Draft the governing message for tomorrow's memo in one sentence. About 50 minutes.

## Feedback and revision

| Feedback received (peer or instructor) | What I changed, and why |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |

### Worksheet 6.2: Diagnostic memo

*Day 15: Synthesis and the diagnostic memo. Anchor tool: Pyramid Principle with SCQA.*

**Purpose.** Turn your evidence into a two-page argument a decision-maker can act on.

**In brief.**

- An insight says what the findings mean together, for the decision.
- Put the answer first, then support it with three key lines that do not overlap.
- SCQA gets a busy reader to the question and the answer fast.
- Match every verb to the strength of the evidence.

**Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative).** Madhyapur governing message: separation fails mainly at collection, because the contract pays for weight; campaigns alone will not fix it. Key lines: households respond to what crews do; crews respond to what they are paid for; downstream capacity decides whether separation is worthwhile.

**Instructions.**

1. Write your governing message in one sentence.
2. Build the pyramid: three key lines and their evidence.
3. Draft the SCQA opening.
4. Write the memo in two pages or fewer, answer first, ending with the decision to be made.
5. Submit Gate 3 with a revision note and AI disclosure.

#### Pyramid

| Governing message | Key line | Supporting evidence (sources) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

#### SCQA opening

| Element | Your text |
|---|---|
| Situation | |
| Complication | |
| Question | |
| Answer | |

#### Memo draft (two pages; you may attach it as a separate document)

| Memo |
|---|
| |
| |

| Memo |
| --- |
| |
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| |

### Revision note

| What changed since Gate 2 | Why |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |

### AI-use disclosure

| Tool used | For what | How you checked the output |
| --- | --- | --- |
| | | |
| | | |

**A thinker for your case: Richard Rumelt.** Does your argument contain a diagnosis, a guiding policy and coherent action, or is it a list of goals?

| My answer, in one sentence |
| --- |
| |

**Reflection.**

1. Rumelt: does your memo name a critical challenge, or does it list problems?
2. Which sentence in your memo is stronger than its evidence?
3. What will the decision-maker most want to know that the memo does not yet answer?

| My reflections |
| --- |
| |
| |
| |

**Quality checklist.**

- ☐ The governing message comes first.
- ☐ Three key lines that do not overlap.
- ☐ Every figure has a year and a source.
- ☐ Language matches the strength of the evidence.

- ☐ Two pages or fewer.

**Hand in.** Gate 3 (Worksheets 5.1 to 5.3 and 6.1, revised, and the memo) by the end of Day 15. Feedback returned by Day 17.

**Before the next session.** Rest. If you have time, read your memo aloud and cut every sentence the decision-maker would skip. About 30 minutes.

### Feedback and revision

| Feedback received (peer or instructor) | What I changed, and why |
|---|---|
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| | |